

platform with new features and improvements, ensuring that it remains a cutting-edge tool for modern web development.

- **User feedback:** CodePen actively listens to its community and implements feedback to enhance the user experience, making it a tool that evolves with its users' needs.

How to get started with CodePen

Sign up or log in: Go to [CodePen.io](https://codepen.io). Click on 'Sign Up' to create a new account using your email or social media login. If you already have an account, simply log in.

Explore the interface: Spend a few minutes exploring the user interface. Notice the different sections such as the editor, the live preview pane, and the settings.

Check out the navigation menu to see options for viewing pens, collections, and projects created by the community.

Create a new pen: Click on 'Create' and select 'Pen' to start a new coding project. You will see three main panels for HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. These are the sections where you'll write your code.

The right side of the screen displays a live preview of your code output.

Write your code: Start by writing HTML code in the HTML panel. This is where you'll create the structure of your web page.

Use the CSS panel to add styles to your HTML elements, such as colours, fonts, and layouts. Write JavaScript code in the JavaScript panel to add interactivity and dynamic behaviour to your page.

Use preprocessors (optional):

Click on the gear icon in the top right corner of each panel to select preprocessors like SCSS for CSS, Pug for HTML, or Babel for JavaScript. Use these tools to write more advanced and efficient code, which CodePen will compile for you.

Import external libraries: Click on the 'Settings' button in the JavaScript panel to add external libraries and frameworks like jQuery, React, or Bootstrap. These libraries will be available in your code editor, allowing you to leverage their functionalities.

Save and name your pen: Click on the 'Save' button to save your pen. You will need to name your pen and provide a brief description.

Choose whether you want your pen to be public or private (private pens are a PRO feature).

Share your pen: Use the 'Share' button to get a unique URL for your pen. You can share this link with others to showcase your work or get feedback.

CodePen also provides options to embed your pens in websites or blogs.

Explore and fork other pens: Use the search feature to find and explore pens created by other developers.

Click on the 'Fork' button to create a copy of someone else's pen, which you can then modify and build upon.

Join challenges and learn: CodePen hosts regular coding challenges that you can participate in

to improve your skills and creativity. Check out tutorials, collections, and examples available on CodePen to learn new techniques and best practices.

Upgrade to PRO (optional):

Consider upgrading to CodePen PRO for additional features such as private pens, asset hosting, and live view. PRO members get access to advanced collaboration tools, making it easier to work with others in real-time.

Build a portfolio: Organise your pens into collections that showcase your skills and projects. Use CodePen to create a professional portfolio page where potential employers or clients can view your work.

Stay updated and engaged: Follow other developers whose work you admire to stay updated on their latest projects. Comment on and like other pens, join discussions, and participate in community events to stay engaged and connected.

The success of CodePen is a testament to the founders' vision and the power of community-driven development. As the web development landscape continues to evolve, CodePen is well-positioned to remain an essential tool for developers looking to push the boundaries of what's possible on the web.

Several other platforms offer similar features for coding, collaboration, and learning. But CodePen definitely stands out and is worth giving a try. **END** 

 **By: S.V. Rohith**

The author specialises in RPA, Python, and Web 3.0, and has over five years of expertise in creating and managing Telegram bots.

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